RoadBook user manual

RoadBook is a trading diary. You record each trade with its setup, the features it had, its result and screenshots of the chart, and then use filters, statistics and a calendar to learn which setups and features work for you.

Everything is kept in a *roadbook*: a directory of CSV files plus a directory of graphs. You can have several roadbooks and switch between them.

Contents

1. Getting started
2. The main window
3. Trades
4. Adding and editing a trade
5. Setups, features, instruments and currencies
6. Account
7. Find and replace
8. The calendar
9. The graphics window
10. Filters
11. Statistics
12. Saving, backups and the files on disk
13. Keyboard reference

Getting started

Run `python3 rb.py` from the source directory, or the `rb` executable built with `pyinstaller --noconfirm rb.spec`.

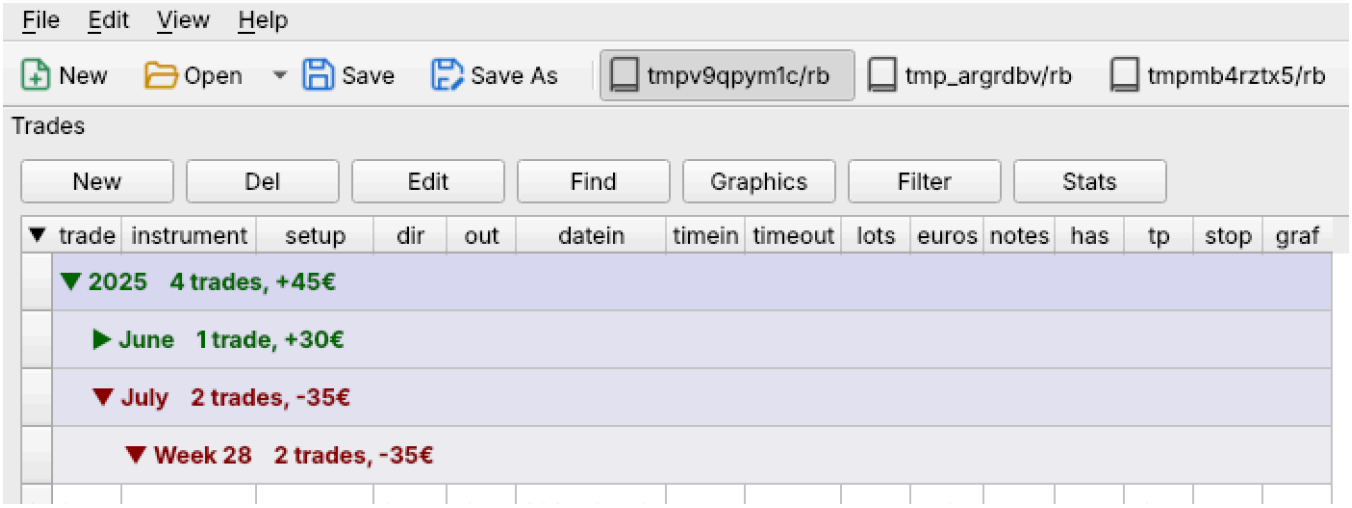
At start RoadBook opens, in this order:

1. the last roadbook you used, or
2. a roadbook found in `$RBDIR` (or `/u/trade` when `RBDIR` is not set), your home directory or your documents directory. If several are found, the one named `rb` is preferred. Without `RBDIR`, when there is no `/u` directory it looks in `~/u/trade`, and when there is no `~/u` either, in `trade` in your documents directory (`~/Documents/trade` on macOS, `Documents\trade` on Windows). New, Open and Save As start there too.

To make your first roadbook, use **File ▸ New Roadbook...** (or the **New** button) and choose a directory and name. It comes with a set of example instruments, setups and features and one example trade. Edit or delete the example trade once you add your own.

> The program is young. Keep a backup of your roadbook somewhere else, and save often.

The main window



- **Toolbar**: New, Open (its ▾ lists recent roadbooks), Save, Save As and Backup, followed by a button for each of your most recent roadbooks. The one that is open is highlighted. Click another one to switch.
- **Left tabs**: Trades, Calendar, Setups, Features, Instruments, Currencies and Account.
- **Right panels**:
  - *Trade N Features*: the features of the selected trade, as check boxes. Checking or unchecking one changes the trade.
  - *Feature Setups*: the setups the selected feature applies to.
  - *Today*: pies with today's result.
- The window title shows the roadbook directory and "(unsaved)" when there are changes to save.

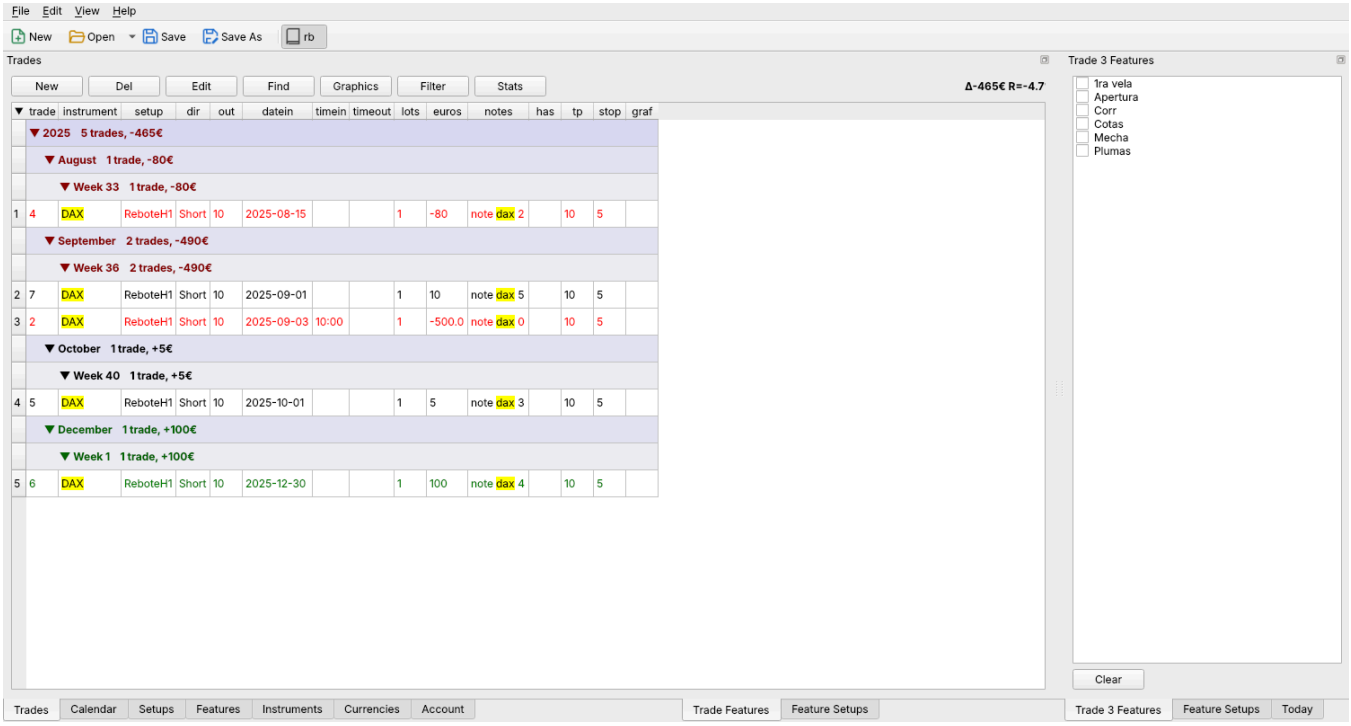
Any tab or panel can be dragged out to float in its own window, or double-click its title bar. This is handy to see the Calendar and the Trades side by side. **View ▸ Side Panels** shows or hides the right panels.

Menus

Menu	Entries
File	New Roadbook (⌘N), Open Roadbook (⌘O), Open Recent, Save (⌘S), Save As (⌘⇧S), Backups (⌘B), Quit (⌘Q)
Edit	New Trade (⌘T), Edit Trade (⌘E), Delete Trade, Find and Replace (⌘F)
View	one entry per tab (⌘1 to ⌘7), Expand or Collapse All Trades (⌘⇧E), Graphics (⌘G), Filter (⌘⇧F), Statistics, Side Panels
Help	About

On Windows and Linux use Ctrl instead of ⌘. On macOS, Quit and About are in the application menu.

Trades



The Trades tab lists the trades grouped by **year**, **month** and **week** (ISO week numbers). Each group header shows how many trades it holds and their total in euros, in green, red or black for a positive, negative or neutral total.

- Click a group header to collapse or expand it. With the keyboard, move to a header and use Enter or Space to toggle it, ← to collapse and → to expand.
- The tiny triangle in the top-left corner of the table collapses every group (▼) or, when all are collapsed, expands them all again (▶).
- At start only the latest year, month and week are open. When the last week has just started (its last trade is on a Monday or Tuesday), the week before stays open too.
- Trades are sorted by date and time inside the groups. Trade numbers are given by the program and cannot be edited.
- Trade rows are green, red or black by result. A trade is positive when its euros (or points, when euros is zero) are above the account's *neutral* value, negative when below minus that value, and neutral otherwise.
- The label at the right of the buttons shows the total and the return on the account for the trades listed (all of them, or the filtered ones).

Cells can be edited in place by double-clicking them. Editing the date moves the trade to its new group and keeps it selected.

Buttons:

Button	What it does
New	opens the trade form for a new trade
Del	deletes the selected trade
Edit	opens the trade form for the selected trade
Find	opens find and replace
Graphics	shows the graphs of the selected trade
Filter	opens the filter window
Stats	opens the statistics window

You can also drop PNG files on the trades table to start a new trade with them.

Selecting a trade updates the *Trade Features* panel, moves the calendar to its day, and refreshes the graphics window if it is open.

Adding and editing a trade

The trade form has these fields:

Field	Meaning
Instrument	what was traded, from the instruments list (you may type a new one)
Setup	the setup used, from the setups list (you may type a new one)
Date, Time In, Time Out	when the trade was opened and closed
Dir	Long or Short
Size	size in lots
TP Δpts	distance to the take profit, in points
Stop Δpts	distance to the stop, in points
Out Δpts	points won (positive) or lost (negative)
Tp at, Out at, Stop at	optional prices. If you give entry and exit prices, the points are computed from them
Euros Out	the money result; if left at zero, it is computed from the points, the size, the instrument's money per point and its currency
Graphics	the screenshots of the trade
Notes	free text

Check the features the trade had in the list of the form. The **AutoFeatures** button below the list checks the features named in the form's notes, as the Features tab's AutoFeatures does (see below), but only for this trade and for the setup chosen in the form. It checks features only, it never unchecks any, and nothing is saved until you press OK. If you type an instrument, setup or feature that does not exist yet, it is added to the roadbook when you accept.

Screenshots

Drop one or more PNG files on the form. When the trade has no graphs yet, RoadBook reads them with OCR and picks the one that best looks like a trade screenshot (a known instrument, TP, stop, result, size, time) as the *primary* graph, and uses it to fill in empty fields. The others become extra graphs. The first OCR takes a while because the OCR engine loads then.

Dropping more files on an existing trade adds them as extra graphs. When you accept, new graphs are copied into the roadbook as `diarygraphs/trade<N><instrument>.png` for the primary one and `trade<N><instrument>.<k>.png` for the others. Graphs that are already in the roadbook are kept as they are, and existing files are never overwritten. Because the names carry the trade number, other tools can match graphs to trades.

Setups, features, instruments and currencies

Each one has its own tab with a table you can edit in place, and New and Del buttons.

- **Setups**: the kinds of trades you take, with a description.
- **Features**: things a trade may or may not have ("with" or "without"), with a description and the setups they apply to. A feature with no setups applies to all. Select a feature to edit its setups in the *Feature Setups* panel. The **aka** column lists other names for the feature, separated by `;` as in the trades' features (for example `Primera;1st candle`). Two more buttons act on the trades listed (the filtered ones when a filter is on). **ClearAll** removes every feature from those trades, after asking. **AutoFeatures** reads their notes and adds each feature whose name or aka name appears there as a whole word, ignoring case; a feature restricted to some setups is only added to trades of those setups. A final lowercase `s` is optional, so `EQL` matches `EQLs` (and `EQLs` matches `EQL`). In aka names a `*` matches any letters within the word, so `EQ*` matches `EQL`, `EQH` and `EQLs`.
- **Instruments**: what you trade. Besides its name it has an alias, its currency, the money per point (`pipmoney`), the point size and a scale used to normalize points between instruments, among others.
- **Currencies**: name, forex pair and value in euros, used to convert results to euros.

Renaming a setup, feature, instrument or currency updates every trade (and feature or instrument) that uses it. Names must be unique and cannot be empty. Something that is in use cannot be deleted; RoadBook tells you so.

Account

The Account tab holds:

- **Account**: the account size, used for the return percentage.
- **Neutral**: the result, in euros, below which a trade, a day or a group counts as neutral rather than positive or negative.
- **Fixed risk**: kept in the roadbook. It does not change any computation yet.
- **Copy Graphs**: whether Save As also copies the graphs.

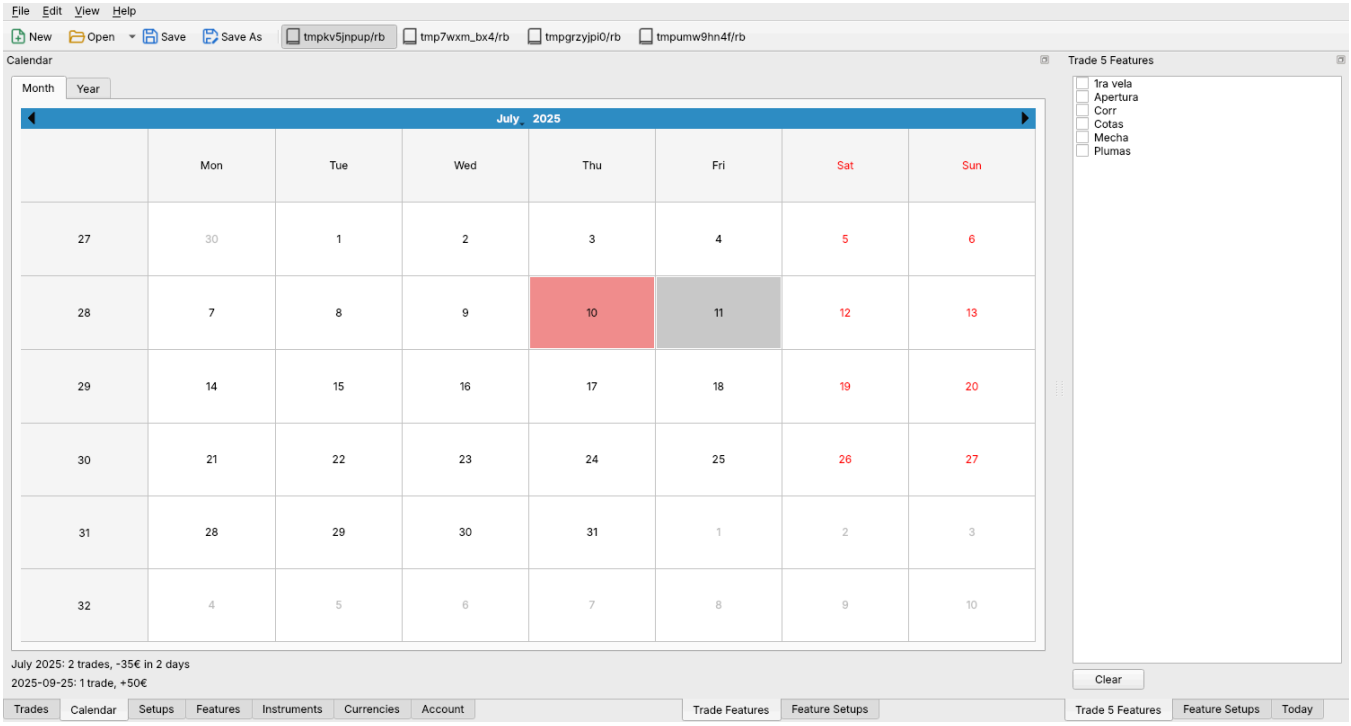
Find and replace

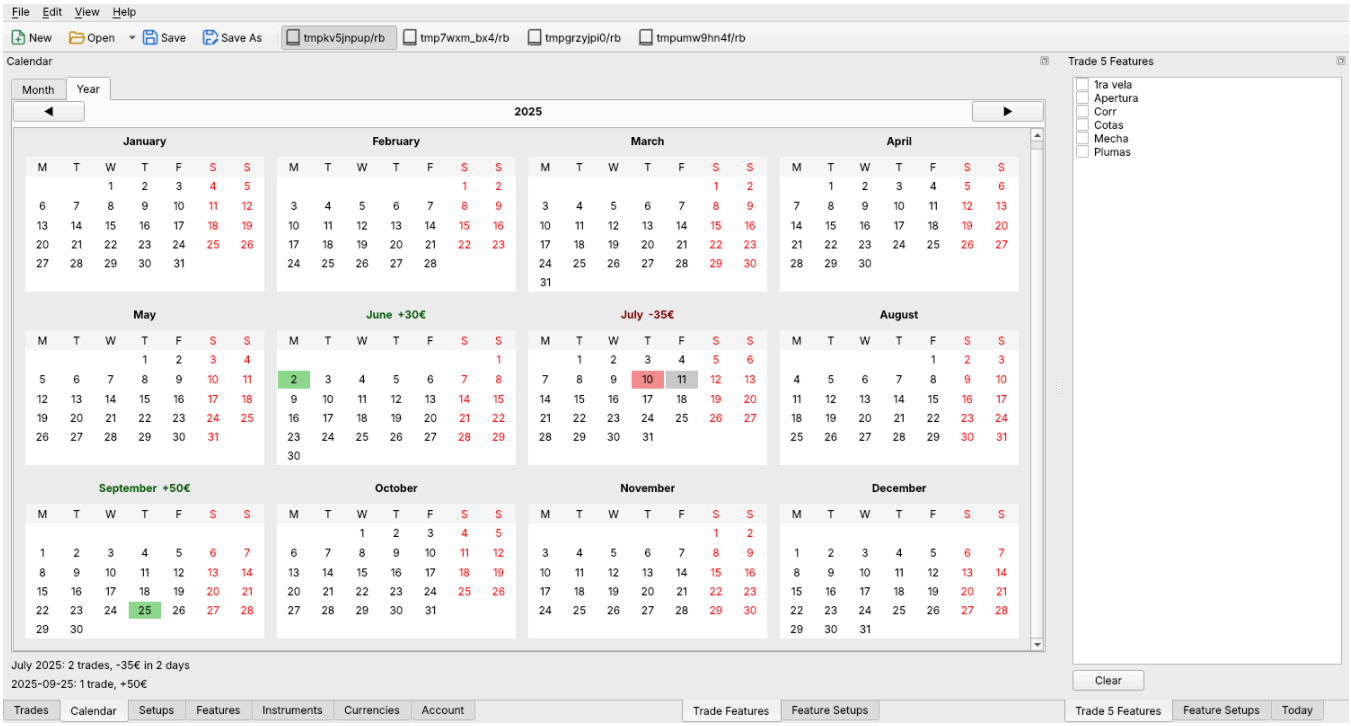
Edit ▸ Find and Replace (⌘F) or the **Find** button of any table opens the find window for the table you are looking at.

- **Find next** and **Find previous** move through the matches, wrapping around at the ends. All matches are highlighted in yellow and the current one in orange. Matches inside collapsed groups are found too; their groups open as needed.
- **Case sensitive** and **Whole words** narrow the search.
- **Replace** changes the current match and moves to the next one. **Replace all** changes every match. The status line says how many were changed and how many were refused.
- Read-only cells (such as the trade number), invalid values and names that are already in use are refused.

Replacing keeps the roadbook coherent. Replacing an instrument, setup or feature name inside trades adds it to the roadbook if it is new, and replacing a name in the Setups, Features, Instruments or Currencies tables renames it everywhere.

The calendar





The Calendar tab shows the days with trades in green, red or grey for a positive, negative or neutral daily total (by the same *neutral* rule as trades). It follows the filter, when there is one.

- **Click a day** to select its first trade in the trades table. The graphics window, if open, shows that trade.
- **Double-click a day** to do the same and switch to the Trades tab.
- **Moving to another month** collapses the trades table to show that month. Months without trades leave it alone.
- Below the calendar you see the month's total and the clicked day's total. Hover over a day to see its total too.

The **Year** tab shows all twelve months of a year with the same colours. Scroll down to see them all, and use ◀ ▶ to change the year. Each month title shows its total; click it to show that month in the trades table. Clicking a day works as in the month view.

The graphics window

Opened with the **Graphics** button or **View ▸ Graphics** (⌘G). It shows the graphs of the selected trade, with the trade's notes beside the buttons (hover over them to read notes longer than three lines).

Control	What it does
Prev, Next or ↑ ↓	previous or next trade
More, or ← →	previous or next graph of the same trade, wrapping around
Home, End	first or last trade
Real Size	shows the graph at its real size
Fit	fits the graph to the window
Zoom +, Zoom –	zooms in or out
Double click	zooms in, zooms in again, then back to fit, in turns. Zooming keeps the point you clicked under the mouse
Two finger double tap, pinch	on a trackpad, zoom like a double click, and in and out
Drag	moves the graph around when it is larger than the window
OS View	opens the graph in the system viewer
Save (⌘S)	saves the drawings

The zoom mode sticks: Real Size, Fit or a zoom factor stay in use as you move through graphs and trades.

Drawing on the graphs

The toolbar at the top of the graphics window draws on the graph:

Tool	Key	What it does
Select	S	click a drawing to select it, shift-click to add more, drag to move them; drag the graph itself to move around
Pencil	P	draws free hand
Line, Arrow	L, A	drag from one end to the other; hold shift when you let go to keep it horizontal or vertical
Circle	C	drag across the box of a circle or ellipse. Double click a line, arrow or circle for its color, width, style and label
Rect	R	drag across a rectangle; double click it for its fill, middle line and label
Text	T	click where the text goes and type; click elsewhere to finish. Double click a text to edit it again
Fib	F	Fibonacci levels; see below

Line, **Arrow** and **Circle** open a window when you double click them, to change their **Color**, **Width** and **Style** (solid, dashed, dotted) and give them a **Label**, with its **Text size** and **Label color**. The label goes **Above**, **Center** (across it; the line stops around the label) or **Below**, and **Left** (at its left end), **Center** (in its middle) or **Right**. For lines and arrows, **Right** puts the label past the right end of the line, kept inside the image.

Rect draws a rectangle, just its border at first. Double click its border (anywhere on it once filled) to set:

- **Fill**, with its color and **Transparency** (0% hides what is under it);
- **Line across the middle**, dashed, with its color;
- **Label** (FVG, OB...), aligned **Center**, **Left** or **Right**, written across the middle of the rectangle (the middle line stops around it), with its **Label color**.

The arrow next to **Rect** picks the kind of rectangle to draw: **Plain** (just the border, in the drawing color) or one already set up, with its colors, fill, middle line and label:

Kind	Looks like
BRK	green border and fill, green middle line
MB	green border and fill, green middle line
FVG	black border, light orange fill, black middle line
IFVG+	orange border and fill, red middle line
IFVG-	blue border, light cyan fill, black middle line

Picking a kind with rectangles selected changes them to it instead.

In these windows the drawing shows each change at once; **Cancel** puts it back as it was.

Fib draws Fibonacci levels. Press on the first point (level 1) and drag to the second one (level 0), or click one and then the other. Then move the mouse and click where the lines end, or double click on the second point to take them to the right edge of the image. While you draw it, a dashed line shows where the second point (level 0) is. Esc or the right button drops a fib not finished. Each level has its number just past the right end of its line, centered on it; lines taken to the edge of the image stop short of it to leave room for the numbers. The arrow next to **Fib** picks the levels:

Set	Levels
OTE (the default)	0.5, 0.62, 0.705, 0.79
Quadrants	0, 0.25, 0.5, 0.75, 1
PO3	the quadrants and −0.5, −1, −1.5, −2, −2.5, 1.5, 2, 2.5, 3, 3.5
Custom...	a form with 20 levels in two columns: check the ones to draw and type their values

The custom form starts with all the levels above, and two blank ones, and remembers what you set. Its **Draw the diagonal** box adds the dashed line from the first point to the second; the other sets never draw it. Picking a set with fibs selected changes their levels instead.

The ⧉ button at the start of the drawing buttons detaches them as a small floating bar that stays on top of every window, so you can keep it where it suits you. Click ⧉ again, or close the bar, to put it back.

Color, the width box, the line style box (solid, dashed, dotted) and the text size box (**Aa 16** by default, for texts, labels and fib numbers) set how the next drawings look, and change the ones selected. **Clear** deletes every drawing on the graph; **Undo** brings them back. **Undo** (⌘Z) and **Redo** (⌘⇧Z) go back and forth through the changes made to the graph shown; **Delete** (or Del) removes what is selected and Esc unselects it and goes back to Select. Drawings stay on their place on the graph when you zoom.

Drawings are not saved until you press **Save** (⌘S); until then the title says *(unsaved)*. You can move to other graphs and trades and save them all later. Closing the window or quitting asks whether to save them. The drawings of a graph are kept next to it, with its name and the `.drw` extension: `diarygraphs/trade12dax.png` has its drawings in `diarygraphs/trade12dax.drw`. A graph with no drawings left has no `.drw` file.

Filters

Filter opens the filter window. Pick:

- instruments and setups, each with **Is** or **Is not** to keep or drop the checked ones,
- features the trades must have (*With features*) or must not have (*Without features*),
- direction and result,
- day of the week and hour, again with **Is** or **Is not**,
- a **Since** and **Until** date range (ignored when Since is not before Until),
- a **Text** expression (see below; Enter applies it).

Apply filters the trades table, the totals, the calendar and the statistics. **Clear** resets the choices, and **No Filter** shows all trades again.

Text filter

The box after the buttons of the Trades tab filters as you type, and the same expression can go in the filter window's **Text** box. Both filters apply together. An empty box doesn't filter.

A word matches a trade when it is a whole word of the trade's notes or of one of its features, ignoring case. As in AutoFeatures, a final lowercase `s` is optional (`eql` finds EQLs) and `*` matches any letters within a word (`EQ*`).

Expression	Trades shown
`late entry`	with both words (words one after another mean *and*)
`late | early`	with either word
`!late`	without the word
`(a b) | !(c d)`	with a and b, or without both c and d together

`!` applies to the word or parenthesis right after it, *and* comes before `|`. A wrong expression turns red and its tooltip says why; the trades stay as they were until it is fixed. Esc empties the box. Opening another roadbook clears both filters.

Statistics

Stats opens the statistics window for the trades listed (filtered or not).

- The radio buttons at the top choose the unit: Euros, points (Pts), normalized points (PtsNorm), stop points, successes or failures.
- **Tot**, **Avg** and **Cnt** choose totals, averages and counts.
- The buttons on the left show or hide each chart: the cumulative plot, results split by positive, negative and neutral, results per day, week and month, and totals per day, week, month, setup, instrument, weekday and hour. **One** and **All** show one or all charts, and **Size +** and **Size –** make them larger or smaller.

Comparing these with filters on different features is the point of the program: it shows which features make trades more likely to fail or succeed.

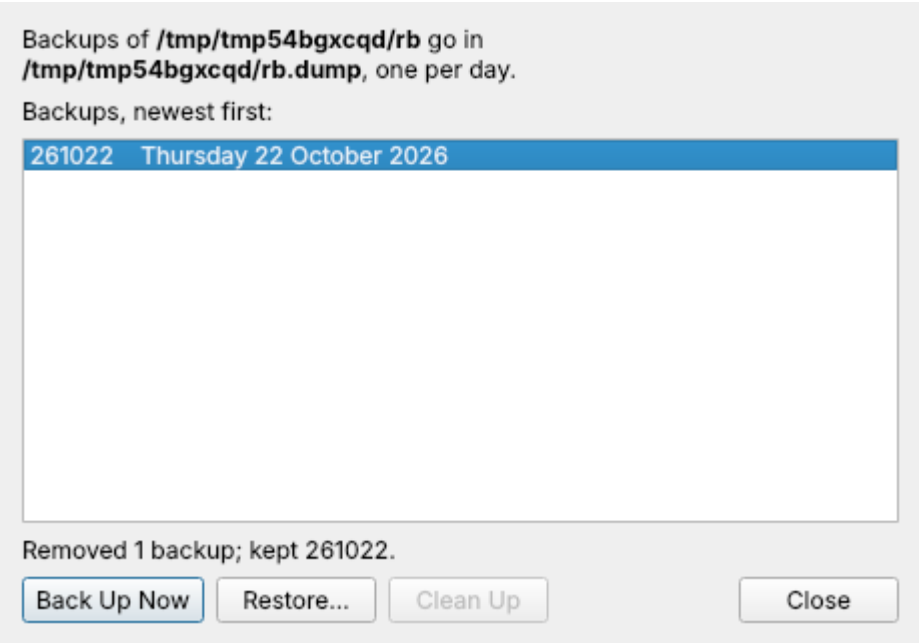
Saving, backups and the files on disk

Save (⌘S) writes the roadbook. Each file is written to a temporary file first and then put in place, so a crash while saving does not leave half a file. The previous version of each CSV is kept with a `~` suffix.

Save As writes the trades listed (so, with a filter on, only the filtered ones) to another directory, and copies their graphs when the account's *Copy Graphs* is set. The open roadbook stays the same.

RoadBook warns you before quitting or opening another roadbook with unsaved changes.

Backups



The **Backup** button (or **File ▸ Backups...**, ⌘B) opens the backups window. Backups of a roadbook at `/a/b/rb` go in `/a/b/rb.dump/`, one directory per day named `YYMMDD` (for example `261022`). Each one holds a copy of the roadbook's CSV files, graphs and drawings with the same layout they have in the roadbook.

- **Back Up Now** makes today's backup. If the roadbook has unsaved changes it offers to save them first; otherwise the backup has what is on disk. Backing up again the same day replaces that day's backup, so there is only one per day. The new backup is written aside and only replaces the old one when it is complete.
- **Restore...** (or double-clicking a backup) copies the chosen backup's CSV files, graphs and drawings back into the roadbook, after you confirm, and reloads it. Changes made since that backup are lost, including unsaved ones. Graph files added after the backup are left in place.
- **Del** deletes the selected backup, after you confirm.
- **Clean Up** removes all backups but the newest one, after you confirm.

A roadbook directory holds:

File	Contents
`account.csv`	the account settings
`trades.csv`	the trades
`setups.csv`	the setups
`features.csv`	the features
`activos.csv`	the instruments
`divisas.csv`	the currencies
`diarygraphs/`	the graphs, as PNG

The CSV files use `;` as separator and can be opened with a spreadsheet if everything else fails. Sets and lists inside a cell (features, graphs) are also separated by `;`. Roadbooks written by older versions are converted when opened.

Keyboard reference

Where	Keys	Action
Anywhere	⌘N, ⌘O, ⌘S, ⌘⇧S, ⌘B, ⌘Q	new, open, save, save as, backups, quit
Anywhere	⌘T, ⌘E	new trade, edit trade
Anywhere	⌘F	find and replace in the table shown
Anywhere	⌘1 … ⌘7	show a tab
Anywhere	⌘G, ⌘⇧F, ⌘⇧E	graphics, filter, expand or collapse all trades
Tables	Home, End	scroll to the top or bottom
Trades, on a group	Enter, Space, ←, →	toggle, toggle, collapse, expand
Graphics window	← →	previous or next graph of the trade
Graphics window	↑ ↓	previous or next trade
Graphics window	Home, End	first or last trade
Graphics window	S, P, L, A, C, R, T, F	select, pencil, line, arrow, circle, rect, text, fib
Graphics window	⌘Z, ⌘⇧Z, Del, Esc	undo, redo, delete the drawings selected, unselect
Graphics window	⌘S	save the drawings